

Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, MA 01027

Finance Committee Meeting Minutes
Tuesday, May 20, 2014

The meeting convened at 7:00 PM

Present:

Finance Committee Members: Ellice Gonzalez, Jackie Brodeur, Mary Cleary, Maryanne Duggan, Aniko Giordano, Margaret Parsons, Joseph Pipczynski, Celeste Whiting.

Visitors: Catherine Cleary

1. Reviewed the minutes of 5/6/14. Voted to accept the minutes 7-0-0 (one member arrived after the vote).
2. Old Business—Ellice shared that she has received positive feedback from townsfolk regarding the performance of the Finance Committee at Town Meeting. People have said that we were well-prepared, knowledgeable and engaged.
3. New Business—Snow Removal. FinCom voted 8-0-0 to transfer the amount of \$30,225.87 from available funds to the snow removal account.
4. Next meeting—We will meet again on Tuesday, June 10 at 7:00 pm to organize the committee and welcome a new member. The town election will be Saturday, June 7th and the Town Meeting will reconvene on Monday, June 16th at 7:00 pm. At the next meeting, we will discuss the municipal finance meeting that several FinCom members attended in Amherst last week.
5. Correspondence—We received two copies of *The Beacon* and a copy of *Laws Relating to Municipal Finance and Taxation*. The book is available to anyone who would like to borrow it.
6. We discussed the town budgeting process and the elementary school budget process. We discussed ways we can help make the process go more smoothly and with greater clarity next year. We would like to see the town's budget become a more collaborative process with more interdepartmental discussion and consensus building. Ellice suggested that we think about forming subcommittees to help research and advocate for capital funding, interdepartmental collaboration, and managing free cash.
7. FinCom discussed the town accounting and the need to discuss this with the select board. We will invite the select board to our next meeting.

FinCom recommends to the select board that the town audit be scheduled and completed as soon as possible.

FinCom discussed requesting monthly accounting reports with the trial balance. We find that this will help us with our planning throughout the year and with our focus on capital funding, collaboration and management of free cash.

The meeting adjourned at 8:00 pm.

Respectfully Submitted by Mary Cleary